

Saturday, 22 August 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON Overcast 21° 13°	BIRMINGHAM Light drizzle 19° 12°	MANCHESTER Light drizzle 19° 13°	GLASGOW Overcast 18° 11°
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01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1

A major search operation is underway after a passenger was feared to have fallen overboard from a cruise ship heading for Dundee.

The alarm was raised on the Ambassador Ambition vessel before it docked in Scotland on Friday. Details are still emerging, but the incident is being treated very seriously.

INCIDENT · UK
- 2

A man has denied a charge in connection with a terror attack at a Manchester synagogue, following an incident earlier this year.

Hekmat Omar Ali Hakim, 49, pleaded not guilty to failing to disclose information regarding terrorist activity. The case is ongoing, with further court dates expected.

CRIME · UK
- 3

A killer has been jailed for murdering a second flatmate, just three years after completing a sentence for an earlier killing.

Eugeniu Neamtu was found guilty of murdering Gheorghe Trica. This shocking case highlights a repeat offender with a history of extreme violence.

CRIME · UK
- 4

A banned driver, who was almost three times the speed limit in a stolen Maserati, has been jailed after killing a pensioner.

Fraser Garden crashed into John Bell's garden in Broughty Ferry, causing the fatal accident. The court heard the tragic details of the incident.

CRIME · UK
- 5

The Prime Minister has announced a new scheme to send high-performing civil servants to mayoral offices across the country.

Rishi Sunak said the initiative aims to help communities 'unleash and unlock their potential'. It's part of a broader government drive to empower local leadership.

POLITICS · UK

What's coming up

- 1 Could Meghan Markle be making a return to acting once she and Prince Harry are back living in the UK?**
Sources close to the Sussexes haven't denied reports that Meghan has been offered an acting role. It would mark a significant shift back into her former career.

ON AIR – If Meghan does return to acting, what kind of roles do you think she should go for?
ROYALS · FUTURE
- 2 Former wrestler Dave Bautista has been confirmed as the new star of the upcoming 'God of War' adaptation.**
He'll be taking over the iconic role of Kratos in the highly anticipated screen version of the popular PlayStation game. Fans are already buzzing about the casting.

ON AIR – Do you think Dave Bautista is the right choice to play Kratos, or is there someone else you'd rather see?
FILM · FUTURE
- 3 Music lovers are being advised to plan ahead for the impact of the huge Reading Festival, kicking off next week.**
The massive music event begins on Thursday 27th August and runs through to Sunday 30th August. Expect road closures and busy public transport in the area.

ON AIR – Are you heading to Reading Festival next week? What acts are you most excited to see?
MUSIC · FUTURE
- 4 Musical icon Angélique Kidjo has made history on the Hollywood Walk of Fame, dedicating her star to Africa.**
The star from Benin spoke passionately about the importance of Africa and Africans to music and culture. It's a huge moment for the continent.

ON AIR – Which African artists do you think deserve more global recognition?
MUSIC · NOW
- 5 Priyanka Chopra Jonas is executive producing a new film about love and caste inequality in India.**
The movie, 'The Cycle of Love', is based on the true story of an Indian artist who cycled from India to Europe to reunite with his wife. It promises to be a powerful story.

ON AIR – Are there any true stories you've heard recently that you think would make a fantastic film?
FILM · FUTURE

On the schedule

- 1 Arsenal have completed a significant £51 million deal to sign England defender Ezri Konsa from Aston Villa.**
Konsa, described as 'hungry to win', joins the Gunners in a major transfer ahead of the new season. It's a big move for both the player and the club.

ON AIR – Do you think £51 million is a fair price for Ezri Konsa, and what impact will he have at Arsenal?

FOOTBALL · UK
- 2 Joe Root enjoyed a winning return as England captain, guiding his side to a huge victory over Pakistan at Headingley.**
England bowled Pakistan out for just 135 on day three of the opening Test, securing an innings and 103-run win. It puts them 1-0 up in the three-match series.

ON AIR – What did you make of England's dominant performance against Pakistan, and can they carry this momentum forward?

CRICKET · UK
- 3 Aston Villa boss Unai Emery has hinted that striker Ollie Watkins could leave the club before the transfer deadline.**
Watkins could follow several other star players out of Villa Park this summer. It would be another big departure for the club.

ON AIR – If Ollie Watkins does leave Villa, where do you think he'd be a good fit, and who should Villa bring in?

FOOTBALL · UK
- 4 Rory McIlroy has bounced back strongly, taking a share of the lead at the BMW Championship in St Louis.**
This follows his disappointing 66th place finish at the St Jude Championship. McIlroy is showing his determination to get back to winning ways.

ON AIR – After a strong start, do you think Rory McIlroy can go on to win the BMW Championship this weekend?

GOLF · INTERNATIONAL
- 5 This weekend's EFL schedule sees some fallen giants and ambitious upstarts looking to make their mark.**
West Ham and Leicester are among the teams aiming to bounce back in the lower leagues. It promises to be an exciting start to the season for many clubs.

ON AIR – Which EFL team are you most excited to follow this season, and do you think they'll achieve promotion?

FOOTBALL · UK

Quick hits

- 1 Research suggests that 'taking a digital detox' for even a short period can significantly boost creativity.**
Stepping away from screens allows the mind to wander and connect disparate ideas, often leading to fresh perspectives and innovative solutions. It's a great excuse to pick up a book or go for a stroll!
- 2 The charming tradition of 'leaving painted stones in public places' for others to find is spreading joy across communities.**
These colourful acts of kindness often carry uplifting messages or whimsical designs, offering a delightful surprise for anyone who stumbles upon them. It's a lovely way to brighten someone's day.
- 3 A new study highlights the surprisingly positive impact of 'gardening on mental well-being' for all ages.**
Connecting with nature, even through a small window box, can reduce stress and offer a sense of accomplishment. Plus, fresh air is always a bonus!
- 4 The humble 'local library' is experiencing a resurgence, becoming a hub for more than just books.**
Many libraries now host workshops, community events, and even offer digital resources, making them vibrant centres for learning and connection. It's a wonderful community asset.
- 5 Research shows that 'listening to classical music' can be surprisingly beneficial for concentration and relaxation.**
Whether you're working, studying, or just unwinding, the intricate patterns and soothing melodies can help focus the mind and calm the spirit. It's not just for concerts!
- 6 A new trend sees more people embracing the simple pleasure of 'baking their own bread at home'.**
The aroma of freshly baked bread filling the kitchen is incredibly comforting, and there's immense satisfaction in creating something delicious from scratch. A true treat for the senses!
- 7 The art of 'keeping a physical journal' is being recognised for its surprising benefits to emotional processing and memory.**
Putting thoughts and feelings down on paper can provide clarity and a record of personal growth, offering a quiet moment of reflection in a busy world. A lovely way to de-stress.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when we're trying to quickly judge if a kettle has truly boiled, without actually looking inside?

ANSWER: ...LISTENING INTENTLY FOR THAT SPECIFIC, FINAL RUMBLE BEFORE THE CLICK!

Q Our survey said that over 55% of us admit to having a particular 'odd habit' they absolutely have to do before enjoying a lovely, fresh glass of water from the tap. What is it?

ANSWER: ...LETTING THE WATER RUN FOR A FEW EXTRA SECONDS, JUST TO MAKE SURE IT'S SUPER CHILLED AND FRESH!

TALK TOPIC

- **You know how sometimes a 'particular type of weather' just makes you feel incredibly happy or reflective?**
Whether it's the sound of rain on the window, a bright sunny day, or even a dramatic sky, what kind of weather brings out the best in you, and why?
- **We all have those 'little everyday sounds' that bring us a surprising amount of comfort or joy, don't we?**
Is it the purr of a cat, the distant whistle of a train, or the kettle boiling? What's your favourite comforting sound, and what memories does it bring back?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Animals.** Did you know that a group of pugs is actually called a 'grumble'?

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Did you know that elephants are the only mammals that can't jump because their legs are too stiff?

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£25 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£3.8 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- Honey never spoils; archaeologists have found pots of honey in ancient Egyptian tombs that are still edible.
- The shortest war in history was between Britain and Zanzibar on August 27, 1896, lasting only 38 minutes.
- The inventor of the frisbee, Walter Morrison, was originally inspired by flying cake tins at a picnic.
- A 'bibliosmia' is the delightful act of smelling old books.
- Butterflies taste with their feet, allowing them to sense if a leaf is suitable for laying eggs.
- The world's largest snowflake on record was 15 inches wide and 8 inches thick, observed in Montana in 1887.
- Penguins are the only birds that can't fly, but they are excellent swimmers.
- The 'richest' soil on Earth is called chernozem, found in regions like the Ukrainian steppes and Russian plains.

On this day

Day 234 of the year, 131 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Immaculate Heart of Mary (Roman Catholic calendar of 1960); Christian feast day: John Kemble; Christian feast day: Queenship of Mary; Christian feast day: Blessed Symeon Lukach. Star sign Leo, birthstone Peridot.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1973 — Howie Dorough, American singer-songwriter and dancer
- 1967 — Layne Staley, American singer-songwriter (died 2002)
- 1972 — Paul Doucette, American singer-songwriter, guitarist, and drummer
- 1961 — Roland Orzabal, English singer and musician
- 1947 — Cindy Williams, American actress and producer (died 2023)
- 1945 — Ron Dante, American singer-songwriter and producer
- 1967 — Ty Burrell, American actor and comedian
- 1957 — Holly Dunn, American country music singer-songwriter (died 2016)

THE DAY TODAY

- 2006 — Pulkovo Aviation Enterprise Flight 612 crashes near the Russian border over eastern Ukraine, killing all 170 people on board.
- 1953 — The penal colony on Devil's Island is permanently closed.
- 1972 — Rhodesia is expelled by the IOC for its racist policies.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1989 — Nolan Ryan strikes out Rickey Henderson to become the first Major League Baseball pitcher to record 5,000 strikeouts.
- 2003 — Chief Justice of the Supreme Court of Alabama Roy Moore is suspended after refusing to comply with a federal court order to remove a rock inscribed with the Ten Commandments from the lobby of the Alabama Supreme Court building.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 2004 — Versions of The Scream and Madonna, two paintings by Edvard Munch, are stolen at gunpoint from a museum in Oslo, Norway.

1981 — Far Eastern Air Transport Flight 103 disintegrates in mid-air and crashes in Sanyi Township, Miaoli County, Taiwan. All 110 people on board are killed.

- 1985 — British Airtours Flight 28M suffers an engine fire during takeoff at Manchester Airport. The pilots abort but due to inefficient evacuation procedures 55 people are killed, mostly from smoke inhalation.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 235 of the year, 130 days left in 2026. Today Battle of Kursk Day (Russia); Christian feast day: Ascelina; Christian feast day: Asterius, Claudius, and Neon; Christian feast day: Éogan of Ardstraw. Star sign Leo, birthstone Peridot.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1986 — Neil Cicierega, American comedian and musician
- 1983 — James Collins, Welsh footballer
- 1992 — Nicola Docherty, Scottish footballer
- 1960 — Gary Hoey, American guitarist, songwriter, and producer
- 1970 — Jay Mohr, American actor, producer, and screenwriter
- 1974 — Ray Park, Scottish actor and stuntman
- 1972 — Martin Grainger, English footballer and manager
- 1986 — Sky Blu, American rapper and DJ

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1954 — The Cruise of the Kings, a royal cruise organised by the Queen Consort of Greece, Frederica of Hanover, departs from Marseille, France.
- 2007 — The skeletal remains of Russia's last royal family members Alexei Nikolaevich, Tsarevich of Russia, and his sister Grand Duchess Anastasia are discovered near Yekaterinburg, Russia.
- 1966 — Lunar Orbiter 1 takes the first photograph of Earth from orbit around the Moon.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1975 — The start of the Wave Hill walk-off by Gurindji people in Australia, lasting eight years, a landmark event in the history of Indigenous land rights in Australia, commemorated in a 1991 Paul Kelly song and an annual celebration.
- 2023 — A business jet carrying key leadership members of the Russian private military company Wagner Group crashes, killing all ten people on board.

Coming to cinemas

AUGUST 2026	
FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome
SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)
OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

11 — FORWARD PLANNING • SPORT

On the sporting calendar

AUGUST 2026

22–23

Belgian Grand Prix (F1)